THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 8 ENGLISH — READING SKILL PAPER SET 05

Reading Comprehension | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 40 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 20**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A has one factual passage with 10 questions (1 mark each).
3. Section B has one literary passage (poem or story) with 10 questions (1 mark each).
4. Write the question number before each answer.

SECTION — A (Reading Comprehension: Factual / Discursive Passage) 10 Marks

Read the passage and answer the questions.

1. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 10

Road Safety: Everybody's Responsibility

Every year thousands of lives are lost on Indian roads. Many of these accidents are not caused by bad luck but by careless habits: driving too fast, crossing the road without looking, using a mobile phone while riding, or ignoring red lights. A moment's carelessness can change a family's life forever.

Traffic rules exist for a reason. Traffic lights tell drivers when to stop and when to move, and zebra crossings give pedestrians a safe place to cross. Helmets and seat belts do not prevent an accident, but they greatly reduce the chance of serious injury if one occurs. A helmet that is not fastened under the chin is of little use, for it will fall off at the very moment it is needed.

Children are particularly at risk, because they are small, quick and sometimes unaware of danger. A child who runs into the road after a ball may not notice an approaching vehicle, and a driver may not notice the child. This is why schools teach students to cross at zebra crossings, to walk on the footpath and to look both ways before stepping off the kerb. Parents, too, should set an example by following rules themselves; a child who sees an adult jumping a red light will soon learn to do the same.

The government can help by building better roads, installing signals and punishing offenders, but real safety begins with ordinary citizens. If every rider wears a helmet, every car passenger fastens a seat belt and every pedestrian uses the crossing, the number of accidents will fall sharply. As a popular slogan puts it, 'Better late than never, and better never than dead.'

(i) Many road accidents are caused by: 1

(a) old vehicles **(b)** bad weather
(c) narrow roads **(d)** careless habits

(ii) Helmets and seat belts: 1

(a) are optional for adults **(b)** prevent all accidents
(c) reduce the chance of serious injury **(d)** increase speed

(iii) An unfastened helmet is useless because it: 1

(a) is uncomfortable **(b)** is heavy
(c) will fall off when needed **(d)** looks bad

(iv) Children are at greater risk because they are: 1

(a) careless by nature **(b)** driving bikes
(c) small, quick and unaware of danger **(d)** always late

(v) The word 'kerb' in paragraph 3 means: 1

(a) the edge of the pavement **(b)** a sign board

(c) a type of vehicle (d) a traffic light

(vi) State whether True or False: Helmets prevent all accidents. Correct if false. 1

(vii) Give two examples of careless habits that cause accidents. 1

(viii) What is the use of a zebra crossing? 1

(ix) Why should parents follow traffic rules themselves? 1

(x) Who, according to the writer, plays the real role in road safety? 1

SECTION — B (Reading Comprehension: Literary Passage — Poem / Story) — 10 Marks

Read the text and answer the questions.

2. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 10

The Boy Who Counted Stars

In the village of Dhani, where electricity came only for three hours each evening, a boy named Mohan used to lie on the roof every night and count the stars. His mother thought it a waste of time, and his father, who was a farmer, said that stars could not fill a stomach. Mohan only smiled and went on counting.

One winter, a science teacher named Ms Iyer was posted to the village school. On her first evening she saw a thin boy sitting alone on the school roof, a notebook on his knees. "What are you writing?" she asked. "The number of stars I can see," said Mohan. "Last night I counted four hundred and twelve. But tonight there are more." Ms Iyer smiled. "There are more because the moon is thinner tonight," she said. "Would you like to know why?"

That was the beginning of a friendship. Ms Iyer brought him an old pair of binoculars and a book on the sky. Mohan learned that some of the 'stars' were planets and that the stars he counted were suns, far away from us, some of them bigger than our own. He learned to find the Pole Star and the Great Bear. Soon, other children joined him on the roof and the village began to call the group the 'Star Club'.

Years passed. Mohan studied hard, won a scholarship and became an astronomer. When the village honoured him with a garland, his father stood in the crowd with tears in his eyes. "I said stars could not fill the stomach," he whispered. "I did not know they could fill a life."

Mohan bent down, touched his father's feet and said, "They filled mine because you let me look."

(i) Mohan spent his evenings: 1

(a) counting stars on the roof (b) helping on the farm

(c) studying in school (d) playing cricket

(ii) Mohan's father thought that stars: 1

(a) were useless to teachers (b) were planets

(c) could not fill a stomach (d) were very beautiful

(iii) Ms Iyer helped Mohan by giving him: 1

(a) a telescope (b) money

(c) binoculars and a book (d) a lamp

(iv) Mohan's father cried because: 1

(a) he was proud and regretful of his earlier words (b) he was sad

(c) he had lost something (d) he was ill

(v) The word 'astronomer' means a person who studies: 1

(a) stars and planets (b) plants

(c) oceans (d) rocks

(vi) State whether True or False: Electricity was available all day in Dhani. Correct if false. 1

(vii) What did Mohan learn from the book on the sky? 1

(viii) What was the group of children on the roof called? 1

(ix) Why were there more stars visible on the second night? 1

(x) What did Mohan mean by 'because you let me look'? 1

END OF QUESTION PAPER **Total: 20 Marks**

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